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Large-cap IPOs: does valuation or a quant rule tell you more?

Across 96 IPOs worth $5bn+ (2010–2025), buying after listing lagged the index at every horizon, and simple rules that bet against new issues beat valuation-based buying — though the strongest of them depends heavily on the 2020–21 boom. In a pilot of 19 deals valued from their prospectuses with comps (EV/EBITDA, EV/Sales, P/E, dividend yield) and a DCF, the IPOs that traditional valuation rated attractive did not outperform. The same lag shows up across 131 large listings in Korea, India, Hong Kong and China.

Data snapshot 2026-10-19 · version 1.3.0 · code, data and tests · download results (CSV)

+14%
Median gain for allocation buyers, offer to first month-end

−49 pts
Median 3-year excess return, bought at first month-end

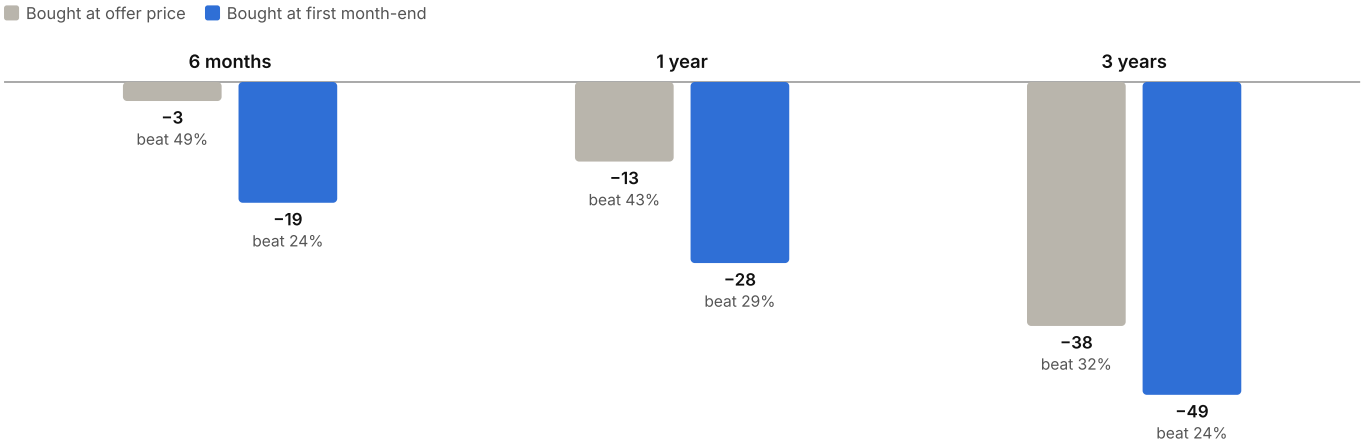
24%
Deals that beat the index over 3 years after listing

+0.04
Rank correlation of price-to-sales at offer with 3-year excess (0 = no signal)

What happened after listing

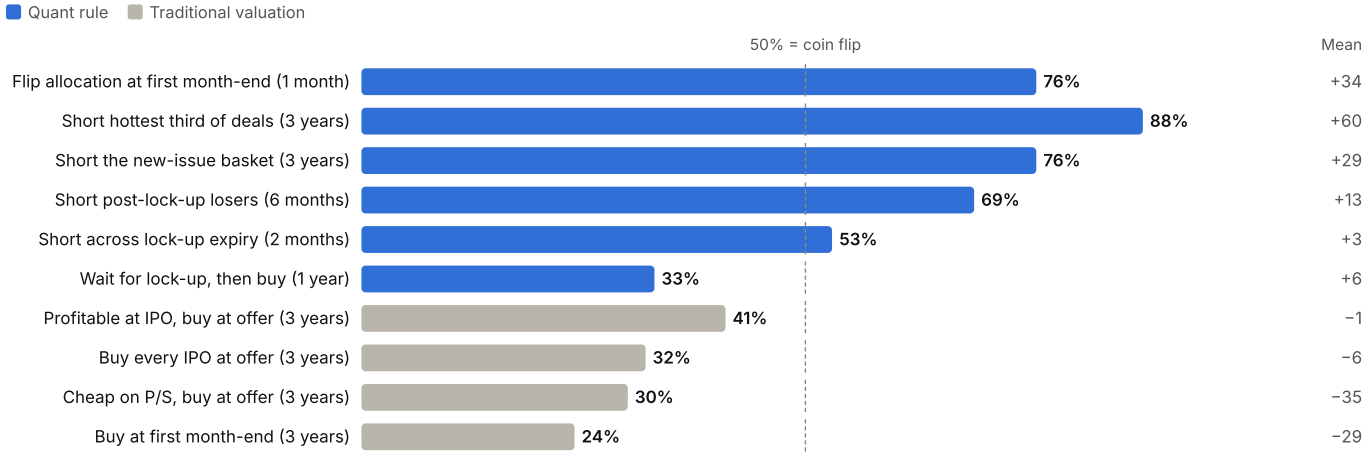
The typical deal trailed the index at every horizon

Median return minus benchmark (S&P 500 for US deals, MSCI ACWI for global). Label below each bar: share of deals that beat the index.



Systematic rules beat every valuation screen

Share of deals where the rule beat the index (flipping: share above the offer price). Mean excess return at right. Before trading and borrowing costs.



Does it survive other specifications?

Each row reruns the whole study with one change. Anyone can rerun these with `make robustness`.

> Robust: buying after listing lagged the index in every variant. Not robust: the hot-deal short. Without the 2020–21 boom it earned +2 pts on average and was right 67% of the time; for 2010–2018 listings, −9 pts and 50%.

Variant	Deals	Median 3y excess, after listing	Beat index, 3y	Median 3y excess, from offer	Short hottest third: mean 3y	Right	P/S rank corr.
Base case ($5bn+, 2010-2025, US + global)	96	−49	24%	−38	+60	88%	+0.04
Very large only ($10bn+)	77	−50	21%	−39	+68	90%	−0.04
Mega only ($25bn+)	35	−47	21%	−33	+69	90%	+0.18
US only	79	−57	24%	−41	+61	90%	+0.08
Global only	17	−29	25%	−14	+57	80%	+0.34
Excluding the 2020-21 boom	64	−34	30%	−19	+2	67%	+0.19
First half only: 2010-2018 listings	32	−10	34%	−2	−9	50%	+0.15
Second half only: 2019-2025 listings	64	−76	17%	−41	+63	88%	+0.11
Excluding the five best 3-year winners	91	−52	19%	−40	+75	96%	−0.12

Traditional valuation vs quant strategies

Pilot: 19 IPOs valued from their prospectuses with comparable multiples (EV/EBITDA, EV/Sales, P/E, dividend yield; P/B for the one financial) and a standard 10-year DCF. Each traditional rule buys the IPOs it rates attractive; the quant rules run on the same 19 deals.

Strategy	Type	Entry	Trades	1 month	6 months	1 year	3 years
Dividend yield above industry	Traditional	offer	2		+8% (50%)	−16% (50%)	−70% (0%)
Dividend yield above industry	Traditional	first month-end	2		−10% (50%)	−32% (0%)	−84% (0%)
P/E below industry	Traditional	offer	3		−2% (33%)	−6% (33%)	−10% (33%)
P/E below industry	Traditional	first month-end	3		−8% (33%)	−13% (33%)	−22% (33%)
EV/EBITDA below industry	Traditional	offer	1		−15% (0%)	−37% (0%)	−99% (0%)
EV/EBITDA below industry	Traditional	first month-end	1		−27% (0%)	−48% (0%)	−110% (0%)
EV/Sales below industry	Traditional	offer	3		−5% (33%)	−32% (33%)	−76% (0%)
EV/Sales below industry	Traditional	first month-end	3		−24% (33%)	−48% (0%)	−90% (0%)
Comps value above offer	Traditional	offer	4		+4% (50%)	−15% (50%)	−57% (0%)
Comps value above offer	Traditional	first month-end	4		−11% (50%)	−27% (25%)	−68% (0%)
DCF value above offer	Traditional	offer	2		−13% (50%)	−33% (0%)	+24% (100%)
DCF value above offer	Traditional	first month-end	2		−8% (0%)	−29% (0%)	+48% (50%)
Buy every IPO	Benchmark	offer	19		+15% (58%)	+24% (42%)	+20% (53%)
Buy every IPO	Benchmark	first month-end	19		−13% (16%)	−11% (26%)	−7% (26%)
Short hottest third	Quant	first month-end	7		+34% (100%)	+20% (86%)	+72% (100%)
Short new-issue basket	Quant	first month-end	19		+13% (84%)	+11% (74%)	+7% (74%)

Strategy	Type	Entry	Trades	1 month	6 months	1 year	3 years
Flip allocation	Quant	offer	19	+32% (79%)			
Wait for lock-up, then buy	Quant	month 6	19			+25% (37%)	

Each cell: mean excess return vs the index (share of trades that beat it). Short positions earn the index return minus the stock's. Flipping is the raw gain from the offer to the first month-end. Before costs.

> Traditional valuation rarely called an IPO cheap, and its picks did not beat the index: most rules bought 1–4 of the 19 deals. The size of the valuation gap did not predict returns either — rank correlation of the comps gap with 1-year excess return −0.50, DCF gap −0.36 (positive would mean cheap IPOs did better). Over the same deals, flipping allocations and shorting the hottest third did better. Pilot sample: treat as indicative.

How each IPO was valued at its offer price

The IPO's multiple at the offer price against its industry (Damodaran, January of the IPO year). Comps and DCF gaps: fair value ÷ offer value − 1; positive = priced cheap.

Deal	EV/EBITDA (ind.)	EV/Sales (ind.)	P/E (ind.)	Div. yield (ind.)	Comps gap	DCF gap	Traditional rules that buy	3y vs index
Kenvue	14.6x (16.8x)	3.0x (3.6x)	25.9x (27.7x)	3.6% (2.2%)	+21%	−62%	Dividend yield above industry; P/E below industry; EV/EBITDA below industry; EV/Sales below industry; Comps value above offer	−99
Coupang	– (41.7x)	4.7x (5.6x)	– (65.4x)	– (0.0%)	+19%	−89%	EV/Sales below industry; Comps value above offer	−87
Warner Music	24.6x (21.8x)	3.4x (4.7x)	49.8x (38.1x)	1.9% (0.6%)	+16%	−59%	Dividend yield above industry; EV/Sales below industry; Comps value above offer	−40
Synchrony	– (35.3x)	– (8.7x)	9.6x (16.5x)	– (1.0%)	+5%		P/E below industry; Comps value above offer	−2
HCA Healthcare	7.1x (6.8x)	1.3x (0.6x)	12.8x (13.5x)	– (0.4%)	−3%	−50%	P/E below industry	+70
Saudi Aramco	7.5x (3.7x)	4.7x (0.6x)	15.4x (10.3x)	4.4% (4.8%)	−42%	+98%	DCF value above offer	+10
Airbnb	– (22.8x)	7.5x (3.4x)	– (65.2x)	– (0.1%)	−49%	−81%	none	+67
Hilton	19.5x (10.7x)	3.5x (2.4x)	55.9x (27.4x)	– (1.6%)	−51%	−113%	none	+10
Zoetis	17.4x (8.9x)	3.8x (3.1x)	29.8x (15.4x)	1.0% (3.1%)	−55%	−63%	none	+26
Facebook (Meta)	33.9x (17.1x)	19.0x (3.9x)	81.2x (31.9x)	– (0.0%)	−61%	+8%	DCF value above offer	+38
Alibaba	37.4x (25.3x)	18.7x (0.8x)	44.1x (–)	– (0.1%)	−61%	−45%	none	+118
Snap	– (20.7x)	40.3x (6.8x)	– (64.8x)	– (0.1%)	−69%	−98%	none	−46
Ferrari	15.7x (7.9x)	3.9x (0.9x)	37.4x (11.1x)	– (4.2%)	−70%	−59%	none	+94
Uber	– (8.3x)	5.8x (1.2x)	75.9x (14.4x)	– (2.3%)	−75%	−61%	none	−106
Twitter	– (23.2x)	38.1x (4.2x)	– (39.3x)	– (0.0%)	−76%	−77%	none	−58
Snowflake	– (24.0x)	107.9x (8.8x)	– (46.9x)	– (0.7%)	−79%	−88%	none	−6
Arm Holdings	60.7x (8.6x)	19.1x (2.8x)	99.9x (20.9x)	– (1.1%)	−83%	−89%	none	+383
Zoom	654.0x (20.2x)	26.1x (7.0x)	1217.0x (70.8x)	– (1.0%)	−90%	−93%	none	+129
Rivian	– (45.7x)	– (3.6x)	– (123.2x)	– (0.3%)			none	−123

Asia: Korea, India, Hong Kong and China A-shares

131 listings worth $5bn+ at the offer, 2010–2025: Korea 10, India 28, Hong Kong 60, China A-shares 33. Same returns, rules and statistics as the US + global study.

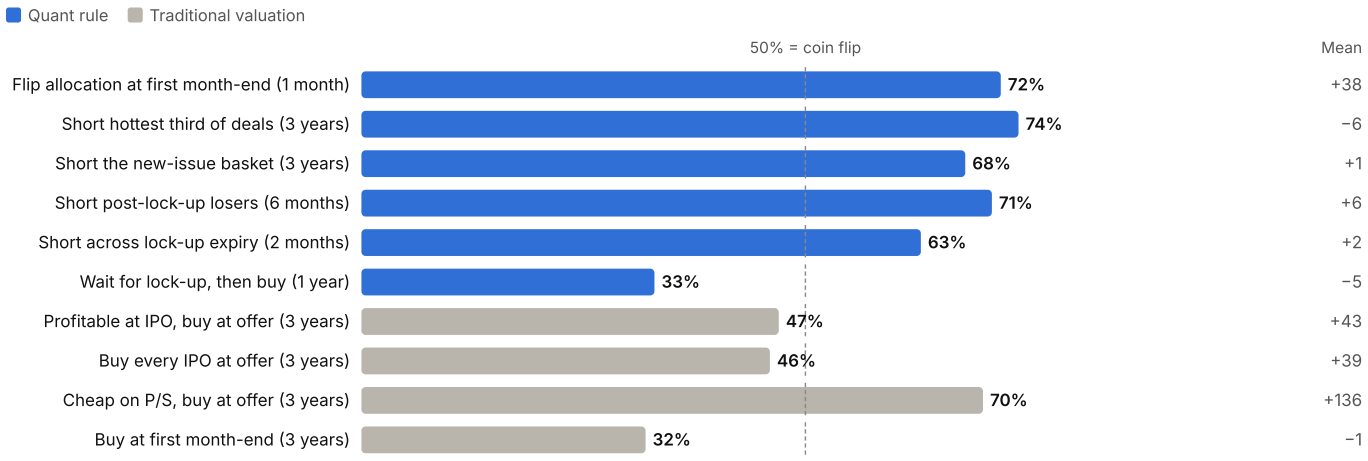
> The same pattern holds in Asia: allocations made money (median first-month gain +15%), but buying after listing lagged the local index — median −25 pts over 3 years, with 32% of deals ahead. The lag was worst in India (−40) and Korea (−35), mildest in China A (−12), where regulators long held offer prices down and first-month gains are largest (median +47%). Shorting the hottest third was right 74% of the time (79% outside 2020–21) but its mean is −6 pts: a few China A deals that kept soaring (mean −71 pts within China A) wipe out the gains, so the rule needs position limits there. One difference from the US + global study: IPOs that were cheap on price-to-sales did better here (70% beat the index over 3 years from the offer, median +32 pts), though Asian revenues are approximate.

Market or variant	Deals	1st-month gain	1y excess after listing	3y excess after listing	Beat index 3y	3y excess from offer	Short hottest third, mean 3y	Right
All Asia ($5bn+, 2010-2025)	131	+15%	−15	−25	32%	−5	−6	74%
Korea	10	+27%	−25	−35	10%	−33	+76	100%
India	28	+18%	−23	−40	31%	−52	+16	50%
Hong Kong	60	+4%	−9	−24	33%	−15	+34	87%
China A-shares	33	+47%	−19	−12	39%	+31	−71	67%
Very large only ($10bn+)	81	+10%	−17	−25	29%	−8	+17	83%
Excluding the 2020-21 boom	106	+11%	−10	−18	35%	0	−24	79%
First half only: 2010-2018 listings	59	+7%	−10	−15	34%	+1	−20	79%
Second half only: 2019-2025 listings	72	+26%	−25	−32	30%	−16	+27	69%

Benchmarks: KOSPI 200 (KODEX 200 ETF) for Korea, Nifty 50 (Nifty BeES) for India, Hang Seng (Tracker Fund) for Hong Kong, CSI 300 for China A-shares; total return in local currency. Market rows re-rank the hottest third within that market.

Rules across all Asian deals

Share of deals where the rule beat the local index (flipping: share above the offer price). Mean excess at right.



Asian valuation pilot: Hong Kong, China A and India

15 prospectuses (Hong Kong 5, China A 5, India 5), valued with the same comps and DCF rules as the US pilot. Most were priced rich (median comps gap −32%, DCF gap −37%). Unlike the US pilot, the gap pointed the right way here: rank correlation with 3-year excess from the offer +0.28 for comps and +0.47 for DCF. Comps called Hindustan Aeronautics, Foxconn Industrial Internet, CATL (A), Mindray Medical cheap; three of these are China A listings, whose offer prices regulators held below market multiples.

Deal	Market	EV/EBITDA (ind.)	P/E (ind.)	Comps gap	DCF gap	1y vs index	3y vs index
CATL (A)	China A	6.6x (22.4x)	14.1x (48.4x)	+98%	+122%	+163	+1979
Foxconn Industrial Internet	China A	9.9x (17.7x)	17.1x (87.6x)	+95%	−104%	−22	−63
Hindustan Aeronautics	India	9.8x (18.6x)	16.7x (35.9x)	+64%	−35%	−55	−53
Mindray Medical	China A	15.1x (26.3x)	22.9x (53.8x)	+43%	−7%	+242	+621
Smoore International	Hong Kong	21.1x (20.8x)	30.0x (49.4x)	−11%	+29%	+163	−17
Coal India	India	11.5x (8.6x)	15.7x (16.3x)	−19%	−4%	+53	+16
Beijing-Shanghai High-Speed Railway	China A	12.3x (10.3x)	23.4x (17.5x)	−20%	−35%	−24	−5
China National Nuclear Power	China A	17.7x (8.3x)	21.3x (22.1x)	−32%	−263%	+130	+89
Nongfu Spring	Hong Kong	26.1x (11.4x)	43.5x (32.6x)	−56%	−34%	+78	+133
Zomato (Eternal)	India	– (12.9x)	– (–)	−58%	−87%	−48	+138
Xiaomi	Hong Kong	47.1x (17.7x)	57.7x (40.5x)	−59%	−80%	−48	+49
Haidilao	Hong Kong	38.3x (10.4x)	68.8x (36.0x)	−68%	−37%	+91	+71
China Tower	Hong Kong	6.8x (6.0x)	95.3x (20.5x)	−79%	−88%	+46	−18
Nykaa (FSN E-Commerce)	India	325.1x (12.9x)	860.2x (–)	−83%	−187%	−20	−55
Paytm (One 97 Communications)	India	– (38.2x)	– (–)	−84%	−97%	−89	−105

Traditional rules vs quant rules on the Asian pilot deals

Strategy	Type	Entry	Trades	1 month	6 months	1 year	3 years
Dividend yield above industry	Traditional	offer	2		−13% (50%)	−39% (0%)	−29% (0%)
Dividend yield above industry	Traditional	first month-end	2		−30% (0%)	−54% (0%)	−41% (0%)
P/E below industry	Traditional	offer	7		+158% (71%)	+96% (71%)	+368% (57%)
P/E below industry	Traditional	first month-end	7		+11% (57%)	−11% (29%)	+81% (29%)
EV/EBITDA below industry	Traditional	offer	4		+84% (50%)	+82% (50%)	+621% (50%)
EV/EBITDA below industry	Traditional	first month-end	4		−5% (50%)	−14% (25%)	+170% (50%)
EV/Sales below industry	Traditional	offer	4		+84% (50%)	+82% (50%)	+621% (50%)
EV/Sales below industry	Traditional	first month-end	4		−5% (50%)	−14% (25%)	+170% (50%)
Comps value above offer	Traditional	offer	4		+84% (50%)	+82% (50%)	+621% (50%)
Comps value above offer	Traditional	first month-end	4		−5% (50%)	−14% (25%)	+170% (50%)
DCF value above offer	Traditional	offer	2		+355% (100%)	+163% (100%)	+981% (50%)
DCF value above offer	Traditional	first month-end	2		+42% (100%)	−21% (0%)	+261% (50%)
Comps and DCF both above offer	Traditional	offer	1		+207% (100%)	+163% (100%)	+1979% (100%)
Comps and DCF both above offer	Traditional	first month-end	1		+16% (100%)	−15% (0%)	+590% (100%)

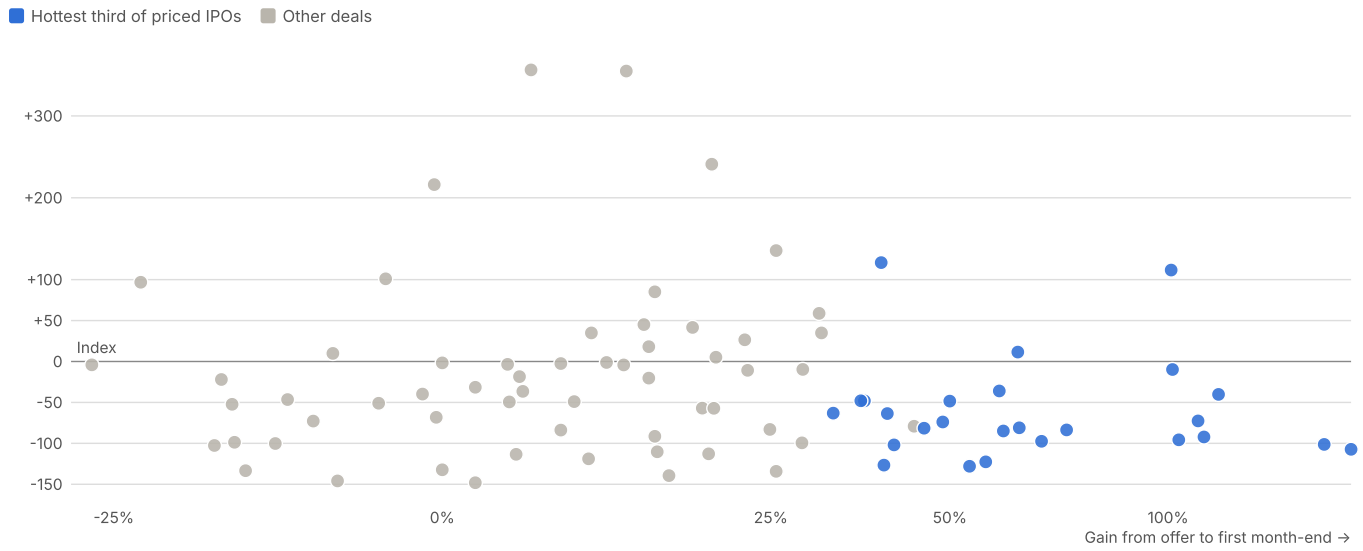
Strategy	Type	Entry	Trades	1 month	6 months	1 year	3 years
Buy every IPO	Benchmark	offer	15		+79% (73%)	+44% (53%)	+185% (53%)
Buy every IPO	Benchmark	first month-end	15		−4% (40%)	−18% (33%)	+33% (40%)
Short hottest third	Quant	first month-end	8		+4% (63%)	+25% (75%)	−78% (50%)
Short new-issue basket	Quant	first month-end	15		+4% (60%)	+18% (67%)	−33% (60%)
Flip allocation	Quant	offer	15	+76% (73%)			
Wait for lock-up, then buy	Quant	month 6	15			−1% (47%)	

Mean excess return vs each deal's local index (share of trades that beat it). Means are dominated by CATL, which beat the CSI 300 by about 20 times its offer price over 3 years; read the share column and treat the whole table as indicative.

Deal by deal

Hottest third: median −77 pts over 3 years, vs −34 for the rest

Each dot is one deal: gain from offer to first month-end (x, log-like scale) against excess return over the following 3 years (y).



Deal	Region	Listed	Value $bn	P/S	1st month	1y vs index	3y vs index	3y after listing
Klarna	US	2025-09	15	5.4x	−8%	−85		
Figma	US	2025-07	19	23.5x	+250%	−46		
Circle	US	2025-06	6.9	4.1x	+485%	+80		
Chime	US	2025-06	9.8	5.8x	+28%	−46		
CoreWeave	US	2025-03	19	10.0x	−7%	+76		
Hyundai Motor India	Global	2024-10	19	2.3x	−7%	+3		
Lineage	US	2024-07	18	3.4x	+10%	−61		
Viking Holdings	US	2024-05	10	2.2x	+31%	+73		
Reddit	US	2024-03	6.4	8.0x	+45%	+200		
Birkenstock	US	2023-10	8.6	5.4x	−15%	−38	−116	−103
Arm Holdings	US	2023-09	55	20.2x	+5%	+144	+383	+356
Instacart	US	2023-09	9.9	3.5x	−1%	−0	−41	−40
Klaviyo	US	2023-09	9.2	15.3x	+15%	−18	−133	−139
Kenvue	US	2023-05	41	2.7x	+14%	−37	−99	−110
Mobileye	US	2022-10	17	10.0x	+26%	+60	−121	−134
Corebridge	US	2022-09	14		−6%	−18	−3	+10
Porsche AG	Global	2022-09	73	2.1x	0%	−12	−132	−132
Life Insurance Corp of India	Global	2022-05	78		−15%	−38	−39	−22
Dubai Electricity & Water	Global	2022-04	34	5.7x	+13%	+6	−5	−20
TPG	US	2022-01	9.0		+14%	+21	+116	+85
LG Energy Solution	Global	2022-01	59	3.9x	+50%	+82	−9	−48
Nubank	US	2021-12	42	24.4x	+4%	−37	−14	−19
HashiCorp	US	2021-12	14	46.7x	+14%	−48	−86	−91
Samsara	US	2021-12	12	46.0x	+22%	−28	+61	+27
Rivian	US	2021-11	67	6650.0x	+54%	−50	−123	−128
GitLab	US	2021-10	11	55.0x	+46%	−22	−60	−82

Toast	US	2021-09	20	16.7x	+25%	-43	-69	-83
Freshworks	US	2021-09	10	33.3x	+19%	-49	-108	-113
Robinhood	US	2021-07	32	17.8x	-8%	-72	-77	-73
Marqeta	US	2021-06	14	46.7x	+4%	-59	-113	-113
Didi Global	US	2021-06	68	3.1x	+1%	-68		
Oatly	US	2021-05	10	22.2x	+40%	-75	-125	-127
Coinbase (DL)	US	2021-04	65	22.4x	+19%	-55	-44	-57
AppLovin	US	2021-04	29	19.1x	-28%	-52	-38	-4
UiPath	US	2021-04	29	48.3x	+29%	-68	-92	-99
Roblox (DL)	US	2021-03	30	32.1x	+44%	-13	-53	-79
Coupang	US	2021-03	60	5.0x	+41%	-65	-87	-102
Bumble	US	2021-02	7.7	13.3x	+57%	-57	-113	-123
Kuaishou	Global	2021-02	61	6.9x	+169%	-30	-83	-107
Affirm	US	2021-01	12	23.8x	+103%	+8	-54	-96
Qualtrics	US	2021-01	15	19.7x	+47%	-26		
DoorDash	US	2020-12	39	17.0x	+40%	+17	-36	-64
Airbnb	US	2020-12	47	13.1x	+116%	+116	+67	-40
JD Health	Global	2020-12	29	11.6x	+111%	-31	-63	-92
Snowflake	US	2020-09	33	82.5x	+109%	+122	-6	-73
Unity	US	2020-09	14	19.6x	+68%	+113	-73	-98
Palantir (DL)	US	2020-09	16	17.8x	+31%	+202	+87	+35
Nongfu Spring	Global	2020-09	31	9.1x	+63%	+59	+95	+12
Beike (KE Holdings)	US	2020-08	24	3.9x	+156%	-41	-49	-101
XPeng	US	2020-08	11	110.0x	+37%	+152	-16	-48
Li Auto	US	2020-07	10	50.0x	+39%	+154	+226	+121
Warner Music	US	2020-06	13	2.8x	+18%	+5	-40	-57
Royalty Pharma	US	2020-06	17	9.4x	+73%	+8	-35	-84
Saudi Aramco	Global	2019-12	1,700	5.2x	+10%	-3	+10	-1
Datadog	US	2019-09	7.8	26.9x	+26%	+263	+203	+136
Peloton	US	2019-09	8.1	8.8x	-13%	+227	-102	-99
Budweiser APAC	Global	2019-09	46	7.1x	+4%	-27	-33	-37
CrowdStrike	US	2019-06	6.6	26.4x	+101%	+188	+361	+112
Chewy	US	2019-06	8.8	2.5x	+59%	+96	+23	-36
Slack (DL)	US	2019-06	16	39.2x	+44%	+12		
Uber	US	2019-05	82	7.3x	-10%	-32	-106	-100
Pinterest	US	2019-04	13	12.7x	+63%	+8	-39	-81
Zoom	US	2019-04	9.2	27.9x	+101%	+275	+129	-10
Lyft	US	2019-03	24	11.0x	+9%	-56	-115	-119
Tencent Music	US	2018-12	21	7.8x	+2%	-41	-147	-148
SoftBank Corp	Global	2018-12	64	1.9x	-9%	-24	-59	-47
Nio	US	2018-09	6.4	128.0x	+12%	-79	+414	+355
Meituan	Global	2018-09	55	8.9x	-0%	+15	+215	+216
Pinduoduo	US	2018-07	24	18.5x	+19%	+9	+318	+241
Xiaomi	Global	2018-07	54	3.1x	+4%	-50	+2	-4
AXA Equitable	US	2018-05	11		+7%	+2	+8	-3
Spotify (DL)	US	2018-04	27	5.3x	+23%	-11	+24	-11
Dropbox	US	2018-03	9.2	8.4x	+49%	-6	-32	-74
iQiyi	US	2018-03	13	4.7x	-14%	+24	-67	-52
Siemens Healthineers	Global	2018-03	35	2.1x	+19%	+33	+33	+5
Altice USA	US	2017-06	22	2.4x	+8%	-44	-42	-49
Snap	US	2017-03	24	60.0x	+33%	-20	-46	-63
Japan Post Holdings	Global	2015-11	52		+36%	+1	-19	-48
Ferrari	US	2015-10	9.8	3.1x	-3%	-2	+94	+101
Alibaba	US	2014-09	168	19.8x	+31%	-13	+118	+59
Citizens Financial	US	2014-09	12		+9%	+14	+50	+35
Synchrony	US	2014-07	19		0%	+38	-2	-2
Ally Financial	US	2014-04	12		-3%	-25	-54	-51
Santander Consumer	US	2014-01	8.3		+7%	-39	-80	-84
Hilton	US	2013-12	20	2.1x	+11%	+17	+10	-4

Twitter	US	2013-11	14	26.8x	+60%	+44	−58	−85
Zoetis	US	2013-02	13	3.0x	+29%	−5	+26	−10
Facebook (Meta)	US	2012-05	104	26.7x	−22%	−63	+38	+97
Zynga	US	2011-12	7.0	6.4x	−6%	−92	−148	−146
Groupon	US	2011-11	13	9.1x	−13%	−95	−139	−133
Glencore	Global	2011-05	60	0.4x	−0%	−23	−68	−68
HCA Healthcare	US	2011-03	16	0.5x	+13%	−20	+70	+45
Kinder Morgan	US	2011-02	21	2.6x	+2%	+17	−30	−32
Nielsen	US	2011-01	8.2	1.6x	+13%	+22	+40	+18
General Motors	US	2010-11	50	0.4x	+4%	−43	−45	−49
AIA Group	Global	2010-10	31		+17%	+24	+72	+42

Excess in percentage points vs the index; "1y" and "3y" measured from the offer price (reference price for direct listings, marked DL). Blank = horizon not reached or company acquired.

Check it yourself

1. Get the code and data: https://github.com/aalqu/IPO-val-vs-q
2. Run the tests and rebuild every number on this page:

```
pip install -e ".[test]"
make test        # unit, data-integrity and regression tests
make results     # writes results/results.json and deal_returns.csv
make robustness  # the table above
ipo-study run --universe asia          # Korea, India, Hong Kong, China A
ipo-study valuation --universe asia    # Hong Kong comps/DCF pilot
```

3. Rebuild prices from a second source and compare: `make crosscheck` (downloads from Yahoo Finance).
4. Change an assumption: `ipo-study run --min-mcap 10 --region US --exclude-cohort 2020-21 --bootstrap 2000`
5. Found an error? Open an issue with the deal, the field, the correct value and a source link. Corrections are logged in `data/corrections.csv`.

Method and limits

- **Universe:** 96 listings worth $5bn or more at the offer price, 2010–2025: 79 US (including 5 direct listings) and 17 global. Five deals excluded for lack of monthly prices.
- **Returns:** buy-and-hold total return from month-end closes (adjusted for splits and dividends), minus the benchmark's total return over the same months.
- **Traditional valuation (pilot):** each IPO's EV/EBITDA, EV/Sales, P/E and dividend yield at the offer price (P/B for financials) against Damodaran's industry multiples for the IPO year and region, and a 10-year DCF with the same rules for every deal. Inputs come from the final prospectus (424B4) and SEC XBRL data; every row links to its filing.
- **Simple screens (all 96 deals):** profitability at IPO, price-to-sales against the sample median.
- **Quant rules:** reconstructed from published research (long-run underperformance, hot-issue fade, lock-up expiry, post-lock-up momentum). They are not any fund's actual strategy.
- **Limits of the valuation pilot:** 19 deals (Porsche excluded for lack of sourceable accounts), so each rule trades only a handful; trailing multiples, not the forward multiples bankers emphasise; basic post-IPO share counts (excluding options and RSUs), which flatter Facebook, Snap, Uber and Airbnb.
- **Not yet verified:** for the other 77 deals, offer prices and valuation inputs are approximate and not yet linked to prospectuses. Prices come from one aggregator; the cross-check against a second source has not yet been run.
- **Asia extension (v1.2):** 131 listings worth $5bn+ in Korea, India, Hong Kong (including mainland companies' H-shares; A+H dual listings tagged) and mainland China A-shares, with monthly prices from Yahoo Finance and local index benchmarks. Offer prices, sizes and revenues are approximate and not yet tied to prospectuses. Three deals have no price history (Haitong H merged, ESR taken private, Sinovel delisted); dropping delisted Sinovel flatters China A results slightly.
- **Asian valuation pilot (15 deals):** Hong Kong (Xiaomi, China Tower, Haidilao, Smoore, Nongfu Spring; HKEX prospectuses), China A (CNNP, Foxconn Industrial Internet, CATL, Mindray, Beijing–Shanghai High-Speed Railway; CNINFO prospectuses, Mindray from its annual report because the prospectus is a scanned image) and India (Coal India, HAL, Zomato, Nykaa, Paytm; prospectuses via SEBI, NSE and the lead managers). Industry benchmarks from Damodaran's China and India files, the Emerging-markets file where a country has fewer than 10 firms in the industry, and the US January 2010 file for Coal India (no earlier India file exists). Korea is not yet valued: DART's search blocks automated access, so it needs an OpenDART API key.
- **Not investment advice.** In-sample results, small groups, no costs.

Code MIT licence; text and results CC BY 4.0. Price data © its providers; see the repository's DATA.md. Cite as: Alqubaisi, A. (2026). Large-cap IPOs, 2010–2025: traditional valuation vs quant rules, v1.3.0 (data to 2026-10-19). https://github.com/aalqu/IPO-val-vs-q